The Food-Mood Connection

Welcome to a New Way of Nourishing Your Mental Wellness

Autumn Persinger, PMHNP-BC | Real Psychiatric Services

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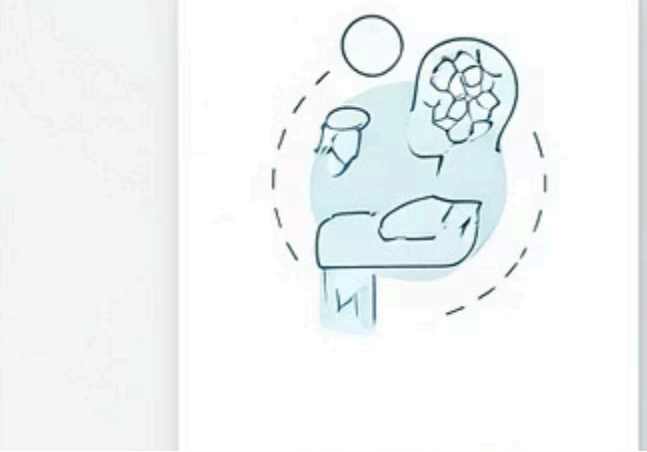
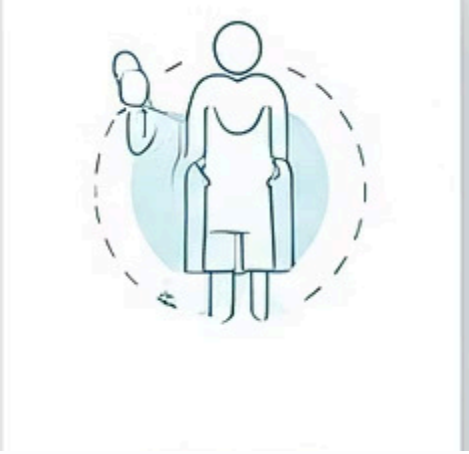



In This Lesson, We'll Explore...

Why You're Here

Validating the common struggles that bring people to this course.

The Core Idea

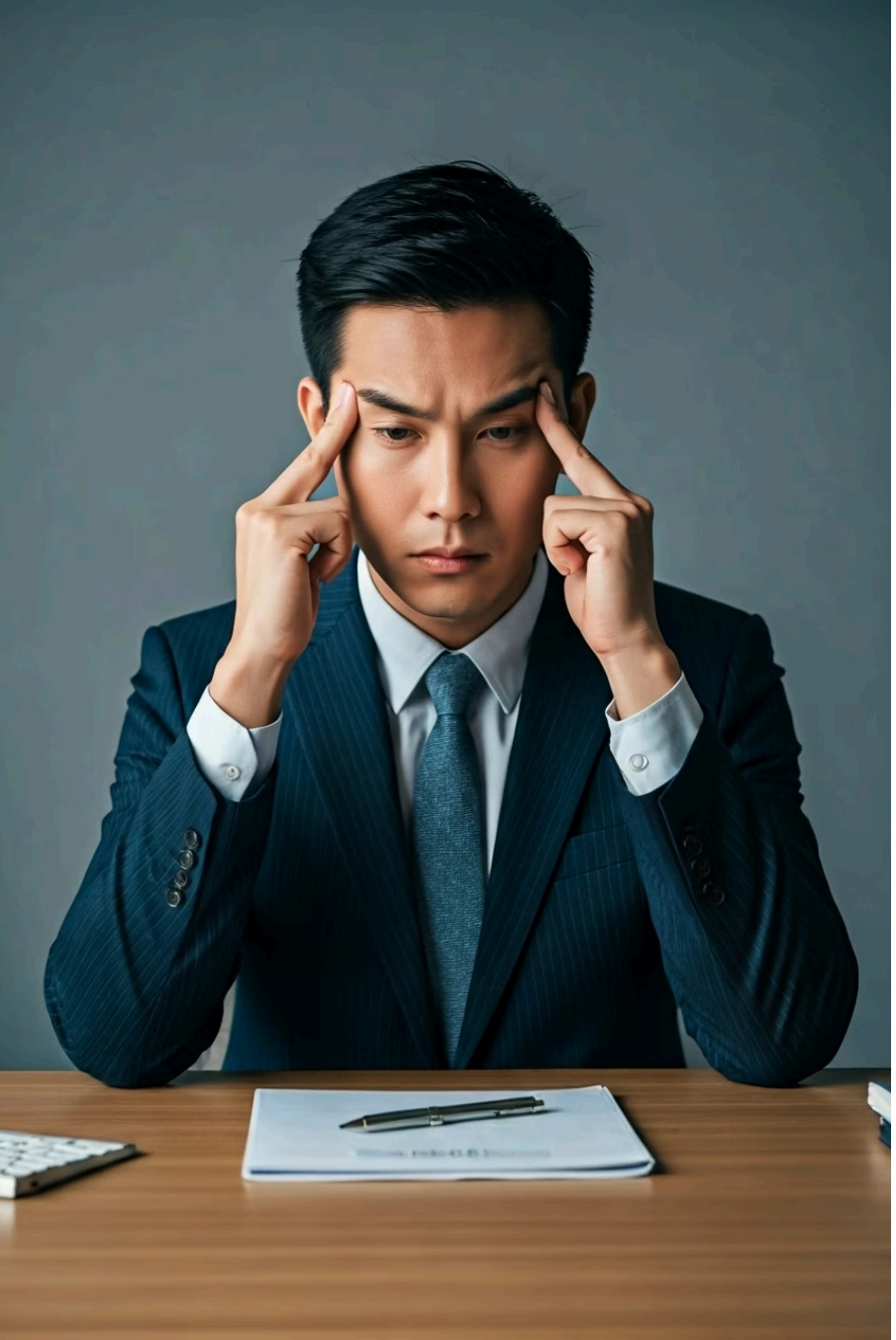
The simple but powerful truth that food builds your brain.

Our Unique Approach

How this journey is different from any "diet" you've tried.

Your Starting Point

Setting a personal intention for your journey ahead.

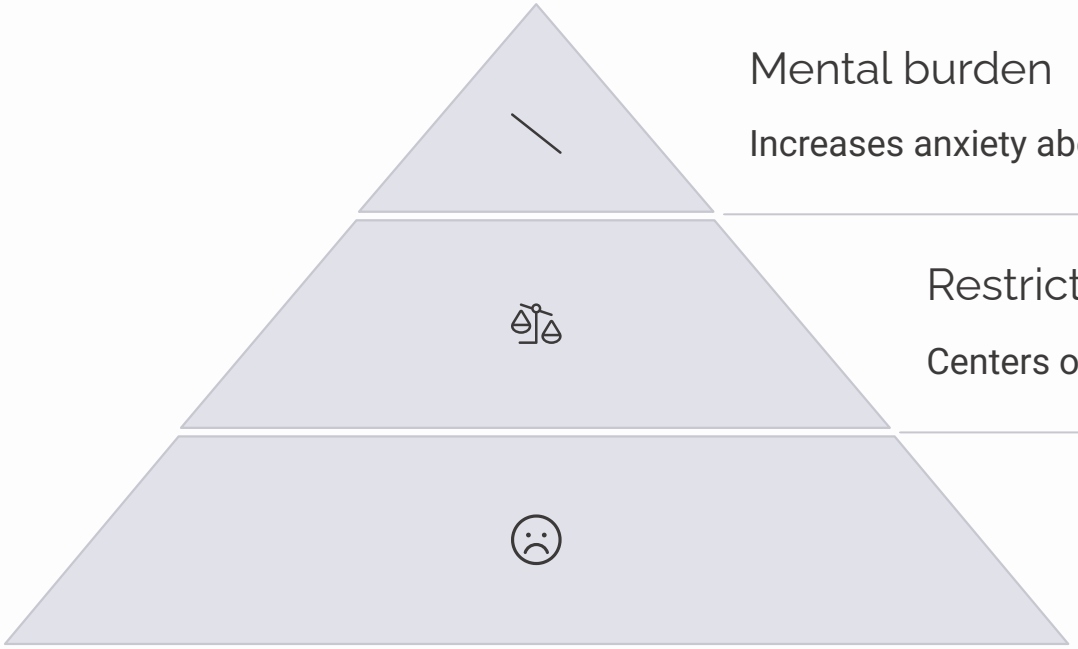


Does This Sound Familiar?

- [ ] **That 3 PM energy crash**
  It derails your afternoon when you need focus most.
- [ ] **The persistent brain fog**
  It makes completing simple tasks feel impossible.
- [ ] **The sudden carb cravings**
  They appear when stress or anxiety levels rise.

You're not imagining it. These aren't signs of weakness. They're signals from your body.

The Problem with "Diet Culture"



Mental burden

Increases anxiety about food choices

Restriction focus

Centers on what to eliminate

Shame cycle

Creates feelings of failure

We're drowning in rules and shame. Most nutritional advice creates a stressful relationship with food.

Our Approach is a Breath of Fresh Air

Nourishment over Restriction

We focus on what to add to support brain health, not what to eliminate.

Curiosity over Judgment

We approach food choices with gentle curiosity about body signals.

Progress over Perfection

We celebrate every small, mindful choice as a meaningful win.

This is a "No-Shame Zone." Lasting change comes from kindness, not criticism.

A Word From Your Guide

> I worked with a client convinced her afternoon anxiety was just part of her job. Through journaling, we discovered it was a blood sugar crash.

Problem identified

Afternoon anxiety linked to blood sugar crash

Simple solution

Added protein and fiber to lunch

Powerful result

Anxiety dramatically improved

The Promise of This Course

Knowledge

Understanding the food-mood connection

Detective skills

Learning to read your body's signals

Empowerment

Making informed choices that nourish you

You will be empowered, not prescribed. You are in control of your journey.

Key Takeaways

1

Science-backed

The Food-Mood link is real, scientific, and powerful.

2

Positive approach

A journey of addition and nourishment, not restriction.

3

Personal power

You can change how you feel by listening to your body.

About Autumn Persinger, PMHNP-BC

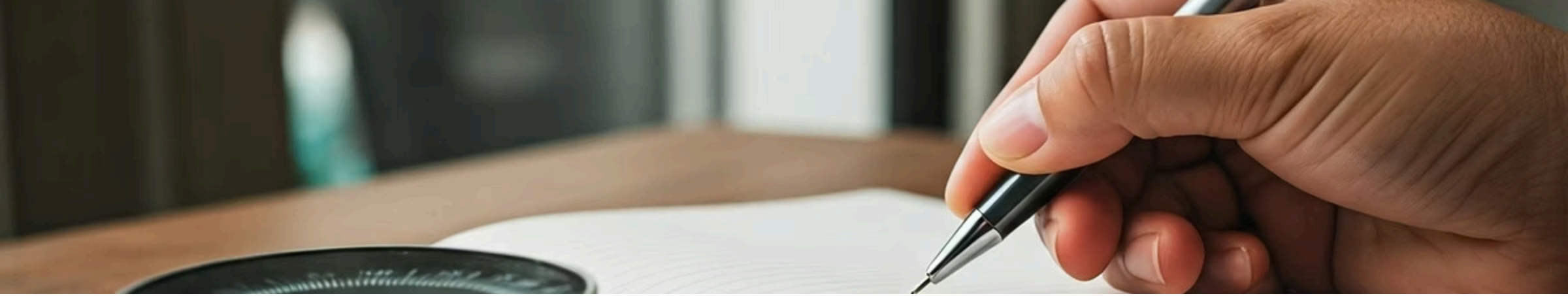
Autumn Persinger brings a wealth of diverse experience and a uniquely holistic perspective to her practice. With a nursing background spanning critical care, emergency medicine, and inpatient psychiatry, she is skilled at maintaining calm and creating safety, even in high-stress situations. Her specialized training as a sexual assault nurse examiner has deepened her trauma-informed approach, ensuring every patient feels respected and heard.

Autumn is passionate about functional psychiatry, exploring how nutritional imbalances and lifestyle habits can influence mental health. She believes in a patient-centered model where her role is to educate and guide, empowering you to make informed decisions about your well-being.

> *"Your care is in your hands. I'm here to educate, guide, and offer options—medical or holistic—that truly align with your goals."*

Clients consistently praise Autumn for her gentle, non-pushy, and nurturing approach. As one patient shared, "She provides a very safe, nurturing environment to open up and discuss whatever I felt I needed to… she never once judged me for them or made me feel uncomfortable."

For more about Autumn's background, philosophy, and the full provider team, visit:
realpsychiatricservices.com/meet-your-providers



What's Next?

You are here

Lesson 1: The Food-Mood Connection

The journey

Understanding how your gut shapes your mood every day

Coming up

Lesson 2: Your Gut as Your Second Brain